

Enterprise RAG and knowledge platforms: Decision Brief

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Executive Summary

Enterprise RAG and knowledge platforms: coverage 2/3 primary questions, 5 recommendation-safe claims, contradiction count 0.

Decision Context

- Goal: Produce an evidence-backed analytical report for a real decision.
- Subject: Enterprise RAG and knowledge platforms
- Decision context: Choose a primary platform for a production pilot in the next two quarters.
- Geography: global
- Time horizon: current

Evaluation Frame

- retrieval quality
- operational maturity
- enterprise controls
- integration surface

Key Findings

- Azure AI Search is strong when enterprise control, managed infrastructure, and Microsoft ecosystem fit matter. [Evidence: da931a1a-0979-4a5e-8761-7e43b6835722, bff99abc-ec56-4847-bb0c-ae1c3118da3f]
- LlamaIndex is strongest as a composable toolkit for teams that want control over ingestion, indexing, routing, and retrieval behavior. [Evidence: 1e4cd1c5-2cd5-451b-bbe9-ec0e10aa2711, 8e4001fd-37ce-46bb-af1c-9ab2d1116cb7]
- The cost is higher engineering ownership and a greater need for internal evaluation discipline. [Evidence: 731a972f-5f59-4811-91ed-0bfd6d291ee9, 13d909ca-cab0-48d2-b9b7-0a35c1cce50f]
- It offers operational maturity but is infrastructure-first rather than a full research-workflow product by itself. [Evidence: dc6b11a0-0520-4387-a6c3-c87d06621e6a, 3eccd1b6-280e-4044-9460-6953e440ad31]
- RAGFlow is positioned around document ingestion and retrieval workflow management rather than only low-level retrieval APIs. [Evidence: 803c2695-e56a-49f0-923d-31f7f3902b3e]
- That makes it attractive for knowledge-heavy use cases where business users need more than a raw vector stack. [Evidence: 821b49ae-5649-4876-87a8-9313b8fc81f8]

Comparative Analysis

- Which offerings are managed platforms versus toolkits?
- Where do retrieval quality and workflow control diverge?
- What are the operational tradeoffs between turnkey and composable stacks?

Recommendation and Decision Posture

- Prioritize options that score well on retrieval quality, operational maturity, enterprise controls. [Evidence: da931a1a-0979-4a5e-8761-7e43b6835722, bff99abc-ec56-4847-bb0c-ae1c3118da3f]
- Treat vendor claims as directional until validated against the target workload. [Evidence: 1e4cd1c5-2cd5-451b-bbe9-ec0e10aa2711, 8e4001fd-37ce-46bb-af1c-9ab2d1116cb7]

Gaps & Risks

- What are the operational tradeoffs between turnkey and composable stacks?
- Prefer pragmatic operating cost and privacy-aware deployment.

Evidence Coverage

- Covered questions: 2/3
- Contradiction count: 0

Sources

- [Azure AI Search](<https://azure.microsoft.com/products/ai-services/ai-search>)
- [LlamaIndex overview](<https://www.llamaindex.ai/>)
- [RAGFlow overview](<https://ragflow.io/>)